

RACHEL HEFTON

7325 CRESTHILL DRIVE #D8
KNOXVILLE, TN 37919
(615)939-5339
Rhefton@vols.utk.edu
Linkedin: Rachel-Hefton

Professional Summary

A highly motivated individual with over five of years research experience. Passionate about finding a career that allows me to leverage my expertise to make a positive impact on the community by advancing the field of horticulture.

Education

The University of Tennessee, Knoxville - Bachelor of Science

Horticulture Science and Production

December 2024

Major GPA: 3.64 | Overall GPA: 3.34

The University of Tennessee, Knoxville - Master of Science

Agronomy

December 2026 (In Progress)

GPA: 3.64

Work Experience

The University of Tennessee, Knoxville – Undergraduate Research Assistant

Specialty Crops Program, May 2022 – December 2024

- Collaborated with the Specialty Crops team to establish the UT Hop Yard by assisting in preparation, planting, and cultivation of hops
- Entered and analyzed research data for tobacco, hemp, ginseng, hops, and ginger trials
- Improved organization and upkeep of lab and field supplies
- Incorporated my education and training to optimize plant care and experimental outcomes

The University of Tennessee, Knoxville – Graduate Research Assistant

Specialty Crops Program, December 2024 – December 2026

Research Experience

- Developed valuable research skills while conducting my experimental design procedure for “The Effects of Supplemental Lighting on the Germination and Growth of Industrial Hemp”
- Planned and executed research trials on American Ginseng (*Panax quinquefolius*)
- M.S. research project: “Optimization of Nitrogen Application Rates and Evaluating their Associated Effects on Fiber Hemp in Tennessee”

Teaching Experience

- Coordinated a lesson on plant care for the Emerald Youth Foundation
- Graduate teaching assistant for PLSC210: Horticulture Principles and Practices